MINUTES OF THE CLARE COUNTY BOARD OF COMMISSIONERS SPECIAL MEETING

Approved 8/19/26

225 W. Main St.
Harrison, Michigan 48625

~~Unapproved~~ minutes
August 5, 2026

Meeting was called to order at 9:00 a.m.

Pledge of Allegiance to the Flag of the United States of America

District 1 Marlene Housler, District 2 Bob Keasey, District 3 Jacob Gross, District 4 Jeff Haskell, District 5 David Hoefling, District 6 Jack Kleinhardt, District 7 Gabe Ambrozaitis and District 8 George Gilmore

COMMISSIONERS ABSENT

District 9 Rick Fancon

OTHERS PRESENT

Clerk & Register of Deeds Lori Mott, Administrator Lori Phelps, Deputy Clerk Isha Walter and members of the public

APPROVAL OF AGENDA

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the agenda, **Motion carried.**

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

A Clare County resident commented on the plaque on the door saying that it was an honorable and nice thing to do.

JUSTICE

1. Homeland Security/Emergency Management
   It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Housler to accept the grant of $9,698.00 from the State of Michigan for the purchase of a Live Scan package and related accessories, **Motion carried.**

HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES

None

PHYSICAL RESOURCES AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENT

1. Airport Grant
   It was moved by Commissioner Ambrozaitis, seconded by Commissioner Hoefling to approve the accept the grant from the Michigan Department of Transportation for the New LED Airport Beacon and the Seal Surface Pavement in the amount of $32,953.91, **Motion carried.**

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION

1. Brownfield Authority
   It was moved by Commissioner Housler, seconded by Commissioner Gross to approve the Clare County Brownfield Redevelopment Authority's Procurement Policy, the revised By-Laws, revised Policies and Procedures, **Motion carried.**

FINANCE AND ADMINISTRATION - continued

2. Health Insurance Review
   Jennifer Martin, a Group Benefit Consultant from The Hilb Group, reviewed the final Health Insurance recommendation with the Board of Commissioners.

   a. It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Housler to opt out of PA152, roll call vote revealed:

      Yeas: (6) being Commissioners Ambrozaitis, Gross, Haskell, Hoefling, Housler and Keasey
      Nays: (2) being Commissioners Gilmore and Kleinhardt
      Absent: (1) being Commissioner Fancon
      Motion carried.

   b. It was moved by Commissioner Haskell, seconded by Commissioner Ambrozaitis to approve the Blue Care Network Health Insurance Plan as presented, **Motion carried.**

3. Fiscal Year (FY) 2027 Budget Review
   Undersheriff Ed Williams discussed a proposal in the Clare County Sheriff's Department budget with respect to making changes to the rank and command structure within the Clare County Jail.

   Administrator Lori Phelps stated that the budget is balanced and went on to review a few components. She stated that she would like to add the passing of the FY 2027 Budget to the agenda for the September 16, 2026 Board of Commissioners meeting.

   Commissioner Gilmore asked for an itemized report to show the requested increase for the Clare County Airport. Commissioner Ambrozaitis responded as MCL 123.66A requires he will be submitting the report in October; however, he will gladly give Commissioner Gilmore a personal copy beforehand.

UNFINISHED BUSINESS

None

NEW BUSINESS

None

GENERAL PUBLIC COMMENT

None

ADJOURNMENT

It was moved by Commissioner Hoefling, seconded by Commissioner Gross to adjourn the meeting, **Motion carried.**

Meeting adjourned at 9:54 a.m.

Lori Mott
Lori Mott, Clerk
Clare County Board of Commissioners

George Gilmore
George Gilmore, Chairman
Clare County Board of Commissioners